BigPrint TV — Daily Start Guide

Everything you run to get the app up on the TV simulator. You need **two terminal windows**: Terminal A runs Metro and stays busy, Terminal B is where you type everything else.

> The **vega** command loads automatically in your terminals. If you ever see **vega: command not found**, run **`source ~/vega/env`** first.

Starting up

Do this each time you sit down to work.

Terminal B — steps 1 to 5

1. Go to the project folder

```
cd ~/Desktop/vega-os-and-fire-tv-env
```

Every other command must be run from inside this folder.

2. Start the TV simulator

```
vega virtual-device start
```

A window opens — that is your pretend Fire TV. Takes a few seconds.

3. Check the TV is connected

```
vega device list
```

Should show: VirtualDevice : tv - x86_64 … If it says "No devices found", step 2 did not work.

4. Connect the TV to your code

```
vega device start-port-forwarding --port 8081 --forward false
```

This is what makes live-reload work. Must be redone every time the TV restarts.

5. Put the app on the TV and open it

```
vega run-app $(find build -name '*_x86_64.vpkg' -path '*Debug*' | head -1)
com.bigprint.tv.main
```

Installs the app and launches it. You should see BigPrint TV on the simulator.

Terminal A — steps 6 and 7

6. Start Metro

```
cd ~/Desktop/vega-os-and-fire-tv-env && npm start
```

Metro sends your code to the TV. This terminal stays busy — leave it open.

7. Open the debugger

```
press the j key in Terminal A
```

Opens React Native DevTools in Chrome. This is the only place your console.log messages appear.

You are ready. Edit any file in `src/` and save — the TV updates instantly, no rebuild needed.

Shutting down

When you finish for the day, so these do not drain your battery.

In Terminal A — stop Metro

```
press Ctrl + C
```

Stops the bundler.

In Terminal B — stop the simulator

```
vega virtual-device stop
```

Shuts down the pretend TV, which uses a lot of CPU if left running.

Only when you need them

Rebuild the app

```
npm run build:debug
```

Required after you change manifest.toml or package.json. Then repeat step 5 to put the new version on the TV.

Restart the app without rebuilding

```
vega device terminate-app --dir . && vega device launch-app --dir .
```

Use when the app freezes or stops picking up your changes.

Run the tests

```
npm test
```

Checks nothing is broken.

Check your code for mistakes

```
npm run lint
```

One warning about system libraries is normal and can be ignored.

Check the app setup is valid

```
vega project doctor
```

Validates manifest.toml. Run this before submitting to Amazon.

If something breaks

The app will not update when you save a file

```
vega device terminate-app --dir . && vega device launch-app --dir .
```

Restarting the app forces it to pull fresh code.

It says "No devices found"

```
vega virtual-device start
```

The simulator is not running. Start it, then redo step 4 as well.

Live reload stopped after restarting the simulator

```
vega device start-port-forwarding --port 8081 --forward false
```

Port forwarding is lost every time the TV restarts. This is the most common problem.

Metro says port 8081 is already in use

```
pkill -f metro
```

Kills the stuck bundler. Then start Metro again.

The debugger will not open with j

```
google-chrome --new-window "http://localhost:8081$(curl -s
http://localhost:8081/json/list | python3 -c "import
sys,json;print(json.load(sys.stdin)[0]['devtoolsFrontendUrl'])")"
```

Opens DevTools in Chrome manually. Metro must already be running.

Two things to never forget

1. Never put spaces in the folder path.
The Vega build tool breaks on them. That is why this folder is named **`vega-os-and-fire-tv-env`** and not **`vega os and fire tv env`**.

2. Your console.log does not show in Metro any more.
It only appears in the debugger (step 7). This is normal for React Native 0.83 — not a bug.